FIRST EDITION

Introduction to the Structured Query Language - SQL

In Only a Few Pages

1

Samuel Mayol

Document Control

Title: SQL Cheat Sheet – Quick Reference Guide
Author: Samuel Mayol
Edition: 1st | **Year:** 2026

Purpose

This cheat sheet provides a concise reference to essential SQL commands, syntax, and concepts for quick lookup and practical use.

Usage Notes

- For educational and reference purposes only
- Syntax may vary by database (MySQL, SQL Server, Oracle, PostgreSQL, etc.)
- Use alongside hands-on practice

Version

v1.0 (2026) – Initial release

Copyright

Copyright © 2026 Samuel Mayol
"In Only a Few Pages" series. All rights reserved.

No part of this document may be reproduced or distributed without prior written permission, except for brief quotations in reviews or educational use.

Feedback

Email: info@inonlyafewpages.com
Website: inonlyafewpages.com

Get the example SQL snippets from this book for free at
https://bit.ly/IOFPSQL

https://www.inonlyafewpages.com/

SQL Cheat Sheet:

I will provide you with a SQL cheat sheet for easy reference.

A. **Building Blocks of SQL: Clauses, Functions & Operators.**

SQL Query Fundamentals: Clauses, Functions, and Operators		
Category	**SQL Keyword**	**Description**
ALIAS	AS	Renames a column or table for better readability.
GROUP BY	GROUP BY	Groups rows with the same values in specified columns.
	HAVING	Filters grouped results based on a condition.
ORDER BY	ASC	Sorts query results in ascending order (smallest to largest).
	DESC	Sorts query results in descending order (largest to smallest).
JOINS	INNER JOIN	Returns matching rows from both tables.
	LEFT JOIN	Returns all rows from the left table and matching rows from the right.
	RIGHT JOIN	Returns all rows from the right table and matching rows from the left.
	FULL JOIN	Returns all rows when there is a match in either table.
FUNCTIONS	AVG()	Calculates the average value of a column.
	SUM()	Calculates the total sum of a column.
	COUNT()	Counts the number of rows.
	MIN()	Finds the smallest value in a column.
	MAX()	Finds the largest value in a column.
WHERE Conditions	LIKE	Searches for a pattern in a column.
	IN	Checks if a value matches any in a list.
	BETWEEN	Checks if a value falls within a range.
	ANY	Compares a value to any value in a subquery.
	EXISTS	Checks if a subquery returns any results.
	ALL	Compares a value to all values in a subquery.
	AND	Combines multiple conditions (both must be true).
	OR	Combines multiple conditions (at least one must be true).
	NOT	Negates a condition.
Comparison Operators	=	Checks if values are equal.
	>	Checks if the left value is greater than the right.
	<	Checks if the left value is smaller than the right.
	>=	Checks if the left value is greater than or equal to the right.
	<=	Checks if the left value is smaller than or equal to the right.
	<>	Checks if values are **not** equal.

B. **Smart Filtering in SQL: EXISTS, NOT EXISTS, IN, NOT IN, ANY, and ALL.**

Understanding EXISTS, IN, NOT EXISTS, NOT IN, ANY, and ALL		
SQL Operator	**Use Case**	**Example Condition**
EXISTS	Checks if a subquery returns rows	`WHERE EXISTS (SELECT 1 FROM departments WHERE department_id = employees.department_id)`
IN	Checks if a value is in a list/subquery	`WHERE department_id IN (1, 2, 3)`
NOT EXISTS	Checks if a subquery **does not** return rows	`WHERE NOT EXISTS (SELECT 1 FROM departments WHERE department_id = employees.department_id)`
NOT IN	Excludes values from a list/subquery	`WHERE department_id NOT IN (1, 2, 3)`
ANY	Compares **at least one** value from a subquery	`WHERE salary > ANY (SELECT salary FROM employees WHERE department_id = 3)`
ALL	Compares to **all** values from a subquery	`WHERE salary > ALL (SELECT salary FROM employees WHERE department_id = 3)`

C. **SQL Date Format Cheat Sheet for All Major Databases.**

The following **SQL Date Format Cheat Sheet** explains various date formats and shows how you might encounter or use them in **major SQL databases**, such as **Microsoft SQL Server, MySQL, PostgreSQL, Oracle, MariaDB, IBM Db2, and Microsoft Access**.

Reference Date: March 28, 2025		
Format Type	**Description**	**Example**
MM/DD/YY	Month-Day-Year with leading zeros	03/28/25
DD/MM/YY	Day-Month-Year with leading zeros	28/03/25
YY/MM/DD	Year-Month-Day with leading zeros	25/03/28
Month D, Yr	Full month name - day - full year	March 28, 2025
M/D/YY	Month-Day-Year with no leading zeros	3/28/25
D/M/YY	Day-Month-Year with no leading zeros	28/3/25
YY/M/D	Year-Month-Day with no leading zeros	25/3/28
bM/bD/YY	Month-Day-Year with spaces instead of leading zeros	3 28 25
bD/bM/YY	Day-Month-Year with spaces instead of leading zeros	28 3 25
YY/bM/bD	Year-Month-Day with spaces instead of leading zeros	25 3 28
MMDDYY	Month-Day-Year with no separators	032825
DDMMYY	Day-Month-Year with no separators	280325
YYMMDD	Year-Month-Day with no separators	250328
MonDDYY	Month abbreviation-Day-Year with leading zeros	Mar 28, 25
DDMonYY	Day-Month abbreviation-Year	28Mar25
YYMonDD	Year-Month abbreviation-Day	25Mar28
day/YY	Day of year / Year (Ordinal or Julian day)	087/2025
YY/day	Year / Day of year (Julian format)	25/087
D Month, Yr	Day - Month name - Year	28 March, 2025
Yr, Month D	Year - Month name - Day	2025, March 28

Format Type	Description	Example
Mon-DD-YYYY	Month abbreviation - Day - Year	Mar-28-2025
DD-Mon-YYYY	Day - Month abbreviation - Year	28-Mar-2025
YYYY, Mon DD	Year - Month abbreviation - Day	2025, Mar 28
Mon DD, YYYY	Month abbreviation - Day - Year	Mar 28, 2025
DD Mon, YYYY	Day - Month abbreviation - Year	28 Mar, 2025

SQL Tips:

- **SQL Server** uses **`CONVERT()`** and **`FORMAT()`** for custom formats.
- **MySQL & MariaDB** use **`the DATE_FORMAT()`** function.
- **PostgreSQL** uses **`TO_CHAR()`** for formatting.
- **Oracle** uses **`TO_CHAR`**() with format models.
- **IBM Db2** supports **`VARCHAR_FORMAT()`**.
- **MS Access** uses **`the FORMAT()`** function similarly to Excel.

We can group formats into:

- Numeric with separators (e.g., MM/DD/YY, D/M/YY)
- Without separators (e.g., MMDDYY, YYMMDD)
- Month names (full and abbreviated)
- Julian day formats [1]
- Mixed styles (like Month D, Yr, Yr, Month D, etc.)

Here are some examples of code snippets for all formats across **SQL Server, MySQL, PostgreSQL, Oracle, MariaDB, IBM Db2, and Access**.

Example in MySQL:

```
SELECT DATE_FORMAT('2025-03-28',
'%m/%d/%y') AS formatted_date; --
Output: 03/28/25
```

Example in PostgreSQL:

```
SELECT TO_CHAR(DATE '2025-03-28',
'MM/DD/YY'); -- Output: 03/28/25
```

[1] **Julian day formats in SQL** represent a date as the day number of the year (from 1 to 365 or 366), making it easy to compare or sort dates by how early or late they are in the year.

About Our Products

Whether you're just getting started or brushing up, this book series is designed to get you up to speed — in only a few pages.

Each title is created to teach real-world skills — clearly, quickly, and effectively. Whether you are a student, a professional, or simply curious, you will learn what matters most — without the fluff.

Complex topics are broken down into simple, practical lessons — allowing you to learn more in less time.

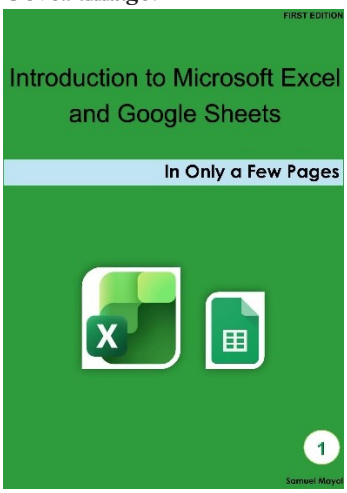
FIRST EDITION

In Only a Few Pages Series

Introduction to Microsoft Excel and Google Sheets

ISBN: 9798275109009
Published: November 2025

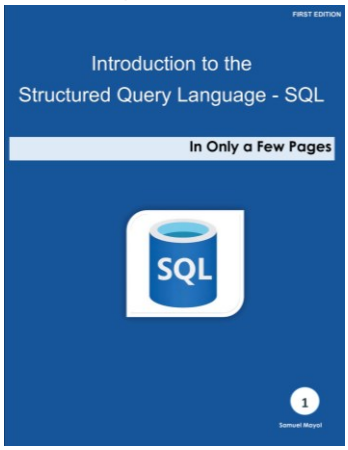
Cover Image:



Introduction to the Structured Query Language - SQL

ISBN: 9798243040983
Release Date: February 2026

Cover Image:

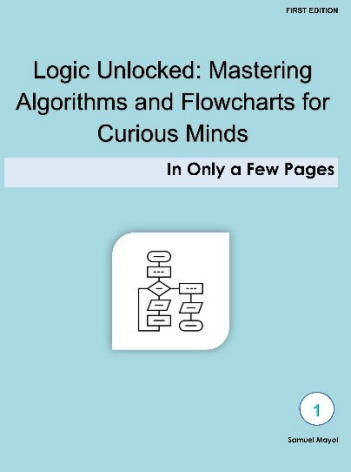


Coming Soon:

Logic Unlocked: Mastering Algorithms and Flowcharts for Curious Minds

Release Date: 2026

Cover Image:



IOFP Mayol

IN ONLY A FEW PAGES, GET SMARTER, FASTER.

www.youtube.com/@IOFPMayol

www.linkedin.com/in/iofp-mayol

www.facebook.com/iofpmayol

www.instagram.com/iofp.mayol

www.x.com/iofpmayol

https://bit.ly/IOFPExcelSheets

inonlyafewpages.com